BONUS 1 · INTERNOMICS

The Internomics Cheat Sheet

Internomics: How to See the Game Behind Every Interaction

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The Internomics Cheat Sheet

Bonus 1 · The eleven mental models on one card

Keep this next to you before the conversations that matter. Find what you're noticing and start with the question it points to.

The 11 Mental Models

#	Model	The question to ask	Watch for (signal it matters)	Quick move
1	See the Game	What's really going on here?	You're rehearsing the perfect sentence before you understand the situation.	Map who can affect the outcome. Include anyone not in the room.
2	See the Payoffs	What payoff would make their behavior make sense?	You're about to call someone irrational or difficult.	List more than one currency. Status and fairness count.
3	Think in Responses	If I do this, what are they likely to do next? And if they do that, what will I do?	"I was just being honest." You're judging the move by your intention.	Ask what your move makes them want to do. Then what?
4	Manage Predictability	What does my predictability enable the other player to do?	People know exactly how to pressure you.	Be consistent where trust matters. Protect your bottom line.
5	See the Equilibrium	What equilibrium have we created?	The same argument keeps coming back. Nobody likes it. Nobody changes.	Change something structural. Not just the next sentence.
6	Map Information & Beliefs	What do they know—or believe—that I don't?	"He knows why I'm upset." Certainty without evidence.	Separate facts from assumptions. Label how confident you are.

#	Model	The question to ask	Watch for (signal it matters)	Quick move
7	Separate Words From Credibility	What makes this message credible?	Would they say this even if it were false?	Look for what’s costly to fake. Make your own truth easy to evaluate.
8	Commitment Changes the Game	What makes this commitment real?	Threats. Deadlines. “Final” offers. “My hands are tied.”	Use a consequence you’ll actually enforce. Ask what binds them.
9	The Shadow of the Future	What changes because there is a next time?	You’ll deal with this person again.	Cooperate conditionally. Leave a path to repair.
10	Diagnose the Coordination Problem	Are we actually in conflict—or are we failing to coordinate?	Everyone wants the outcome. Nobody acts.	Make clear who acts and when. Say it in front of everyone.
11	Change the Game	Do I need a better move—or a better game?	Better words and more pressure keep failing.	Ask what the system actually rewards. Make the smallest testable change.

Quick Model Selector

If you notice…	Start with
You're rehearsing what to say before a big conversation	Model 1 · See the Game
Their behavior seems stubborn or irrational	Model 2 · See the Payoffs
The same argument keeps repeating	Model 5 · See the Equilibrium
You're sure "they know" or sure what they think	Model 6 · Map Information & Beliefs
They said yes but nothing changed	Model 7 · Credibility, then Model 8 · Commitment
You're tempted to win this round with someone you'll see again	Model 9 · The Shadow of the Future
Everyone agrees on the goal and nothing happens	Model 10 · Diagnose the Coordination Problem
The same bad outcome returns no matter who's involved	Model 11 · Change the Game

The Ethical Standard

Truth. Autonomy. Dignity. Informed choice.

- **Truth.** Say only what you believe is true. Don't create a false impression.
- **Autonomy.** The other person stays free to choose. That includes saying no.
- **Dignity.** Would you be comfortable if they saw your full reasoning?
- **Informed choice.** They have the information they'd need to decide well.

Will this work? Should I do it? Never collapse them into one.

Golden Rules

1. **Don't start with the words. Start with the situation.**
2. **Your read is a hypothesis.** Surprise is information. Ask what you misunderstood about the game.
3. **Model → act → observe → update → adapt.** Your model of the game is provisional.
4. **Use as much analysis as the stakes and uncertainty justify.** Most interactions don't need a strategic audit.
5. **Here's what I know. Here's what I think it means. Here's how confident I am.** Certainty feels good. Accuracy is better.

Before Any Important Conversation

- ☐ Who can affect the outcome? Include anyone not in the room.
- ☐ What does each of us actually value? Look past the money.
- ☐ What is my move likely to make them do? And what will I do then?
- ☐ What do I actually know? What am I only assuming?
- ☐ Does my plan pass truth, autonomy, dignity and informed choice?

The Question to Carry

Before your next move, ask:

What game am I playing?

Then look again. The first game you see may not be the real one.

After it’s over, ask:

What did I learn from what just happened?

Don’t just learn what to say. Learn to see the game behind the conversation.